06-26 第一篇

The Revolution of the Steam Engine

Before the steam engine, most work depended on human labour or animal power. Factories, mines（矿井）, and farms could only produce as much as people and horses could manage. [1] All of this changed in the 18th century when inventors improved a simple idea: use steam to push a piston（活塞）back and forth, turning heat into motion. James Watt, a Scottish engineer, made key improvements that made the steam engine practical for factories and railways. His design used less coal and produced more power, which lowered costs and changed how goods were made and transported.

The steam engine changed industry and transport. [2] In factories, steam-powered machines could run looms（织布机）, pumps, and other equipment day and night without stopping. This made cloth, metal goods, and other products much cheaper and easier to produce. On land, steam locomotives（蒸汽机车）pulled trains across countries, carrying people and goods faster than ever. On water, steamships crossed oceans without relying on wind, making travel and trade more reliable. The world seemed to shrink as distances became easier to cover.

Steam power also shaped society in new ways. [3] Cities grew around factories because workers needed to live near their jobs. Railways connected towns and countryside, so people could move to find work or visit family. The demand for coal and iron（铁）rose sharply, creating mining towns and new jobs. At the same time, life became busier and noisier—factories ran around the clock, and trains brought both opportunity and pollution. People began to discuss workers' rights, safety rules, and the effects of industry on health and nature.

Not everything about the steam age was positive. [4] Child labour was common in many factories, and working conditions were often dangerous and unhealthy. Smoke from coal polluted the air in industrial cities. Rivers were sometimes filled with waste from factories. Over time, laws were passed to protect workers and limit pollution. The steam engine had started a revolution—but it also raised questions about how progress should be balanced with human welfare and the environment. These debates continue today as we face similar issues with new technologies.

[5] The steam engine turned heat into motion, and motion into a new world. It helped build the modern age of industry, transport, and global trade. Understanding this history reminds us that technology can change society quickly—and that we must think carefully about how we use it.

选项

A. All of this changed in the 18th century when inventors improved a simple idea: use steam to push a piston back and forth, turning heat into motion. B. In factories, steam-powered machines ran looms, pumps, and equipment; on land and water, trains and steamships made travel and trade faster and more reliable. C. Cities grew around factories, railways connected regions, coal and iron demand rose, but pollution and long working hours also became serious problems. D. Child labour, poor conditions, and pollution led to new laws and ongoing debates about balancing progress with human and environmental welfare. E. The steam engine turned heat into motion and helped build the modern world—technology changes society, and we must use it wisely. F. For example, many museums today display old steam locomotives for visitors to see.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] A [2] B [3] C [4] D [5] E

深度解析

- **[1] A**：
  - **线索**：空前描述工业革命前"work depended on human labour or animal power...factories, mines, farms could only produce as much as people and horses could manage"，空后详述"James Watt...made key improvements...practical for factories and railways...used less coal, more power...lowered costs...changed how goods made and transported"。A选项"All of this changed in the 18th century when inventors improved a simple idea: use steam to push a piston back and forth, turning heat into motion"（这一切在18世纪改变，发明家改进了一个简单想法：用蒸汽推动活塞往复运动，将热转化为动）中"All of this changed"承接空前转折，"18th century...steam...piston...heat into motion"与空后Watt改良、实际应用形成因果，衔接顺畅。
- **[2] B**：
  - **线索**：空前提出"The steam engine changed industry and transport"，空后分述"In factories...steam-powered machines run looms, pumps, equipment day and night...cloth, metal goods cheaper...On land steam locomotives pulled trains...faster...On water steamships crossed oceans without wind...travel and trade more reliable...world seemed to shrink"。B选项"In factories, steam-powered machines ran looms, pumps, and equipment; on land and water, trains and steamships made travel and trade faster and more reliable"（工厂中蒸汽机驱动织布机、泵等设备；陆地和水中，火车与轮船使交通和贸易更快更可靠）中"factories...looms, pumps, equipment...land and water...trains and steamships...faster and more reliable"与空后内容精准对应，逻辑紧密。

- [3] C：
  - **线索**：空前提出"Steam power also shaped society in new ways"，空后列举"Cities grew around factories...workers live near jobs...Railways connected towns and countryside...people move for work or family...demand for coal and iron rose...mining towns, new jobs...life busier, noisier...factories around the clock...trains brought opportunity and pollution...discuss workers' rights, safety, effects on health and nature"。C选项"Cities grew around factories, railways connected regions, coal and iron demand rose, but pollution and long working hours also became serious problems"（城市围绕工厂发展，铁路连通地区，煤铁需求上升，但污染与长工时也成严重问题）中"cities...factories...railways...regions...coal and iron demand...pollution...long working hours...problems"与空后正负两面描述完美对应，衔接自然。
- [4] D：
  - **线索**：空前提出"Not everything about the steam age was positive"，空后详述"Child labour common...working conditions dangerous, unhealthy...Smoke polluted air...Rivers filled with waste...Over time laws passed to protect workers, limit pollution...started revolution—raised questions about balancing progress with human welfare and environment...debates continue today"。D选项"Child labour, poor conditions, and pollution led to new laws and ongoing debates about balancing progress with human and environmental welfare"（童工、恶劣条件和污染促成了新法律以及关于如何平衡进步与人类及环境福祉的持续辩论）中"Child labour...poor conditions...pollution...new laws...ongoing debates...balancing progress...human and environmental welfare"与空后内容精准对应，衔接得当。
- [5] E：
  - **线索**：空[5]位于结尾段段首，空后为"The steam engine turned heat into motion, and motion into a new world. It helped build the modern age of industry, transport, and global trade. Understanding this history reminds us that technology can change society quickly—and that we must think carefully about how we use it."。E选项"The steam engine turned heat into motion and helped build the modern world—technology changes society, and we must use it wisely"（蒸汽机将热转化为动力并帮助构建现代世界——技术改变社会，我们必须明智地使用它）用"turned heat into motion...modern world...technology...use wisely"总结主题，与空后"turn heat into motion...new world...modern age...think carefully about how we use it"形成呼应，收束精准。
- **干扰项分析**：
  - **F. For example, many museums today display old steam locomotives for visitors to see.**：涉及博物馆展示蒸汽机车，易被误填[5]。但F以"For example"引出当代博物馆展览，而空[5]讨论的是蒸汽机历史意义的总结与启示（技

术改变社会、需谨慎使用)，F的"museums display locomotives"属于文化遗产保存的举例，与"turn heat into motion...build modern world...use wisely"的宏观总结焦点不同；F亦未涉及技术进步与社会影响的哲理层面。F属"主题相关但论述层次错位"型干扰。